

Email Clients

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There are so many email services available now, each offering added services like more storage space, and cooler nicknames with your email. The question now arises, how do we manage these email accounts better? That's where Email clients come in to the picture. Email Clients help manage multiple accounts and by doing so make our life a lot easier. MS Outlook is the current ruler of email clients, but is quite expensive as it comes as a bundle with MS Office suite. There are still many other email clients that can be used other than MS Outlook that can manage all your email accounts, and also have additional and newer features. We spent a lot of time digging for the best alternatives you can get for managing your emails. If you are bored of looking at the same old boring screen that MS Outlook displays for you then take a look at the alternatives we have found for you. Did we forget to tell you that these alternatives are all free?

Mozilla Thunderbird 2.0.0.18
Mozilla Thunderbird is one of the most widely used alternatives for MS Outlook and its no fluke why it's so popular — it's free! It is very user-friendly and easy to setup, with a lot of features on offer, such as managing multiple accounts and RSS feeds. Thunderbird can be customised a lot by users, but the add-ons need to be downloaded separately

Setting up accounts is quite easy as there are step by step instructions given — if you have a Gmail account, the settings are preset in Thunderbird.

What's the best free email client out there? If you want to know, keep reading...

There are also many unique features that we noticed when sending emails, such as different presets for paragraphs and headers, which helps you quickly create emails. You can also save your email either as a draft or a template for reuse later. Although you cannot have background images in a template, you can upload and use online images, though this might not be visible by all mail sites or clients.

Thunderbird has an advanced tagging feature that lets you set the following tags to your emails: Important, Work, Personal, To Do and Later. Each one of these tags highlights your email according to the respective colours. You can even mark emails with a Star, which is another way of sorting your emails. Obviously, you can add tags, and even change the colours associated with existing tags.

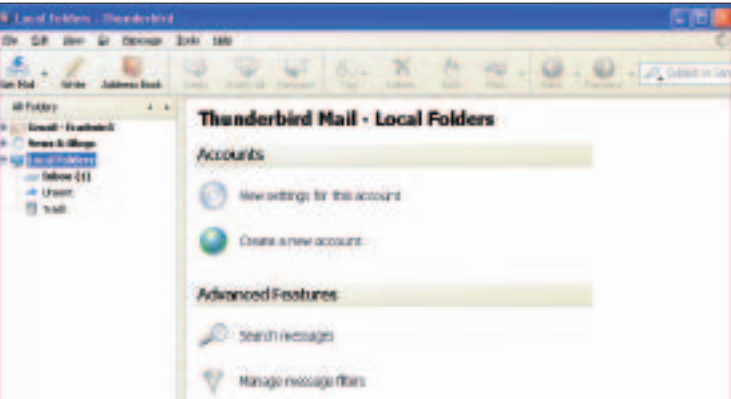
Thunderbird has an advanced Address Book feature as well, where you can create and use multiple Address Books. If you click on the Address Book on the tool bar, it opens a new window where under each Address Book you can create a List. Within those lists is where you can store your contact

cards. Contact cards can be imported from MS Outlook as well as another email client called Eudora, which is also reviewed later.

Notification for Thunderbird includes a pop-up dialogue as well as a sound. With Thunderbird you can also select a .WAV file from your PC to use as an alert.

When you start it off, it looks pretty plain but there is a lot you can do with this email client. Firstly you can customise the email client by downloading themes which are easily available as add-ons from the Mozilla Web site. Other useful add-ons that can be downloaded include a Jabber IM, sync functions with iPods and Nokia phones for contacts, Java Script Debuggers and many more. Thunderbird can be customised a lot by users but the add-ons need to be downloaded separately.

We did notice a few things that could be considered problems: if you have many unread emails in your web-mail, and select the option to get emails immediately while setting up your account, the process of downloading all your emails cannot be stopped unless you close the client. Another problem we found was with setting up RSS feeds which always gave us an error even though we checked and rechecked that everything was fine with the RSS links. Also Thunderbird does not minimize to the system tray if you close or minimise it.



Mozilla Thunderbird — Supports RSS feeds and easy email management